

José Hernán Varela

Senior Backend Developer

jhernan33@gmail.com | Táchira, Venezuela | UTC-4 | Available for fully remote work

<https://devapis.cloud/cv/en/> | <https://github.com/jhernan33> |

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/jhernanvarela>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Backend Developer with 15 years in IT, 5 of them building APIs with Python. I work across both the backend and the infrastructure it runs on: Linux servers, containers, reverse proxy and databases. Available for remote work with teams in Latin America, the United States and Europe.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Manager - PCVARELAVENEZUELA

May 2011 – Present | Full-time

- Sole owner of the IT department and the full technology infrastructure: development, servers, databases and deployment.
- I build internal systems in Python and Django that automate previously manual processes.
- I administer the Linux infrastructure that keeps production running.
- I introduced containerised, reproducible deployments with Docker, replacing the manual process.

Technologies: Python, Django, PostgreSQL, Docker, Linux, Traefik, Nginx

Concurrent / Freelance Engagements

The five engagements below ran concurrently with the IT Manager role, not as consecutive positions.

Backend Developer - Real estate MLS platform (own product in production)

Aug 2025 – Present | Own product, alongside PCVARELAVENEZUELA

- Multi-tenant REST API on Node.js 22, Express 5 and PostgreSQL with Prisma: 353 endpoints across 57 routers, 53 models and 75 incremental migrations, deployed behind Traefik in a distroless, shell-less, non-root Docker image.
- Multi-tenant authorisation with database-backed RBAC and company- and agent-level scope derived from the JWT; cross-tenant leaks were closed as a class (whitelisted projections, output DTOs and generic 404s) and are pinned by 18 security tests.
- Two payment gateways in parallel (Stripe and PayU) with raw-body webhooks, recurring subscriptions and header-based idempotency on mutating operations.
- Redis cache with ETag/304, TTL by data type and targeted invalidation on every write; three-layer rate limiting (Traefik per IP, a global ceiling and per-route limiters backed by Redis).
- Full identity lifecycle: JWT with blacklist, global session revocation on password change, OTP-based 2FA and Google Sign-In with ID token verification against JWKS.
- Suite of 2,154 tests (Jest and Supertest, 163 suites), including guardrail tests that fail if an eliminated architectural pattern reappears.

Technologies: Node.js, Express 5, PostgreSQL, Prisma, Redis, Socket.IO, Docker, Traefik, Stripe, PayU, Jest

Backend Developer - Gsamples-Global (Chile)

Aug 2023 – Jul 2024 | Freelance, alongside PCVARELAVENEZUELA

- Prototype of the REST API for a mining geological sample traceability system.
- Modelled the life cycle of a drill core sample, from the field to storage and laboratory analysis.
- Deployment on a Contabo VPS with Docker and Traefik.

Technologies: PHP, Laravel, MySQL, Docker, Traefik

Backend Developer - Delzam

Jun 2022 – Dec 2023 | Freelance, alongside PCVARELAVENEZUELA

- REST APIs with Django and Django REST Framework for a business management system.
- Service integration on top of that API.
- Eliminated N+1 queries on the most heavily used endpoints: the heaviest one went from over 9,000 queries and 62 s to a single query and 0.29 s.

Technologies: Django, Django REST Framework, PostgreSQL, Docker, Vue.js

Backend Developer - Zippytech Tecnología e Innovación

Dec 2019 – Dec 2022 | Consulting, alongside PCVARELAVENEZUELA

- Architecture of 3 microservices in PHP with Laravel and Lumen.
- Third-party API integration and real-time communication over WebSockets.
- Deployment automation through CI/CD.
- JWT security and fine-grained access control.

Technologies: PHP, Laravel, Lumen, microservices, WebSockets, PostgreSQL, MySQL

Backend Developer - Guásimos Municipality (Local Government)

Feb 2020 – May 2022 | Contract, alongside PCVARELAVENEZUELA

- Overhaul and optimisation of the civil registry records system.
- Municipal public website.
- Geographic information systems with PostGIS.
- Administration of the servers running the platform.
- Integration with existing government systems.

Technologies: Python, Django, PostgreSQL, PostGIS

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, JavaScript (Node.js, ES6+), PHP, SQL / PL-pgSQL

Backend frameworks: Django, Django REST Framework, FastAPI, Express 5, Prisma, Laravel, Lumen

Frontend: Vue.js, HTML5, CSS3, dependency-free JavaScript

Databases: PostgreSQL, PostGIS, MySQL, Redis, SQL Server

Infrastructure: Docker, Docker Compose, Traefik, Nginx, Linux (Ubuntu, Debian, Fedora), Git, shell scripting

APIs and architecture: REST, JWT, WebSockets, microservices

PROJECTS

Professional portfolio and analytics backend

<https://github.com/jhernan33/portfolio-devapis>

- Dependency-free static site served by Nginx, with a self-hosted analytics service in FastAPI and PostgreSQL, behind Traefik and running on Docker Compose.
- Self-managed infrastructure in production, running without interruption since 2024.
- Automated deployment in 18 s — image build, container recreation, health wait and external verification — with automatic rollback when the check fails.
- Visitor IP addresses are never stored: only the truncated network and a salted hash.
- Authentication lives in the application rather than the proxy, so the protection ships with the code.

Technologies: FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Docker, Traefik, Nginx

Municipal management system

- REST API handling citizen service requests.
- Geographic data for the municipality with PostGIS.
- Administrative dashboard built with Vue.js.

Technologies: Django, PostgreSQL, PostGIS, Docker

Legacy system migration to microservices

- Migration from a monolith to a microservice architecture.
- Deployment automation through CI/CD.

Technologies: Laravel, Lumen, PostgreSQL

EDUCATION

Associate Degree in Computer Science - IUFRONT - 1998 - 2000

e-Business Developer - IUTAI - 2008 - 2009

CERTIFICATIONS

21 certifications and over 229 hours of continuous learning between 2023 and 2026, all from Platzi (leading tech education platform in Latin America, over 1 million students). Most relevant to a backend role:

- Python Fundamentals - Platzi - 10/2025
- FastAPI - Platzi - 08/2025
- Django - Platzi - 09/2024
- PostgreSQL - Platzi - 05/2025
- Docker: Fundamentals - Platzi - 10/2025
- Introduction to Linux Server Administration - Platzi - 07/2026
- Preventive Cybersecurity - Platzi - 03/2026
- Backend with ExpressJS - Platzi - 04/2025
- Claude Code - Platzi - 01/2026

LANGUAGES

Spanish: native.

English: fluent technical reading and writing (B2). Spoken English improving (A2-B1). Comfortable with English documentation, code reviews and asynchronous written communication.